LIS 112 BASIC SKILLS IN LIBBRARY AND INFORMATION WORK

Definition of basic terms: library, information, information skills, information and library work, etc. Sources of information: primary, secondary, tertiary and grey literature.

Library: The word library is derived from the Latin word liber, meaning "book." A library is a collection of information resources, such as books, periodicals, digital media, and other materials, organized for use by a community for reference, education, or entertainment. Libraries serve as institutions for knowledge preservation and dissemination, often providing access to databases, computers, and other services for learning and research.

A library is a collection of resources in a variety of formats that is (1) organized by information professionals or other experts who (2) provide convenient physical, digital, bibliographic, or intellectual access and (3) offer targeted services and programs (4) with the mission of educating, informing, or entertaining a variety of audiences (5) and the goal of stimulating individual learning and advancing society as a whole.

A library is generally defined as an organized collection of information resources, such as books, journals, and digital media, made accessible for reading, research, or reference. In modern contexts, libraries serve not just as repositories of knowledge but as community hubs that foster learning, creativity, and innovation. Recent trends highlight how libraries contribute to social development and education, especially through digital transformation and open access to information.

Information is data that has been processed, organized, or structured in a way that provides meaning or context, making it useful for decision-making, communication, or learning. Information can be defined as "data that is endowed with meaning" and becomes valuable when it is interpreted within a relevant context. It plays a fundamental role in knowledge creation by enabling individuals to generate insights from raw data.

INFORMATION SKILL

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Skill- A Skill is typically defined as "the learned ability to bring about pre-determined results with maximum certainty; often with the minimum outlay of time or energy or both.

Information skills refer to a set of abilities required to locate, evaluate, manage, and use information effectively. The sets of skills and competencies required to find and use information, usually in a formal education context.

These skills are essential for academic success, personal decision-making, and professional development, particularly in an age where access to information is vast and complex. They include competencies related to digital literacy, research techniques, and critical thinking.

Key components of information skills include:

1. **Information Literacy**: The ability to recognize an information need, identify relevant sources, and evaluate the credibility and reliability of information.
2. **Research Skills**: Research skills are the ability to find an answer to a question or a solution to a problem. They include your ability to gather information about a topic, review that information and analyze and interpret the details in a way to support a solution.
3. Knowledge of how to use library catalogs, databases, and search engines efficiently to find information.
4. **Critical Evaluation**: The ability to assess the relevance, accuracy, and bias in sources, distinguishing between reliable and unreliable content.
5. **Ethical Use of Information**: Understanding copyright, plagiarism, and proper citation to give credit to original authors.
6. **Digital Literacy**: Navigating digital environments, including online databases and media platforms, to locate, interpret, and use information appropriately.

In practice, these skills are often fostered through education, training programs, and library support services. They are essential not only for academic research but also for navigating everyday information challenges, such as filtering misinformation online

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INFORMATION AND LIBRARY WORK

Information and Library work encompasses the diverse tasks and responsibilities involved in managing, organizing, and providing access to information resources in a library. Information and library work also involves organized collection, management, preservation, and dissemination of information in various forms. This field encompasses a broad range of activities, services, and responsibilities aimed at facilitating access to information and supporting users in their informational needs. Key components of information and library work include:

1. **Collection Development**: Selecting and acquiring materials (books, journals, digital resources, etc.) that meet the needs of the library's users.
2. **Cataloging and Classification**: Organizing materials in a systematic way to make them easily accessible. This involves creating metadata and using classification systems like Dewey Decimal or Library of Congress.

3.Reference and Information Services: Assisting users in finding and using information effectively. This includes answering questions, conducting research, and providing instruction on information literacy.

4. Information Retrieval: Developing and managing systems (databases, catalogs, etc.) that allow users to search for and retrieve information efficiently.

5. Digital Libraries and Repositories: Managing digital collections and institutional repositories, ensuring long-term preservation and access to digital content.

6. Archiving and Preservation: Ensuring the longevity of physical and digital materials through proper preservation techniques and strategies.

7. User Services: Providing services and programs that support the informational, educational, and recreational needs of the community. This can include storytimes, literacy programs, workshops, and more.

8. Information Management: Organizing and controlling information within organizations, ensuring that it is accessible, reliable, and secure.

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9. Technological Proficiency: Utilizing and maintaining library systems, software, and digital tools that support library operations and services.

10. Community Outreach and Engagement: Promoting library services and resources to the community, and forming partnerships with other organizations to enhance service delivery.

11. Research Support: Assisting academic and professional researchers with accessing relevant information, managing data, and using research tools.

12. Policy Development and Administration: Developing policies and procedures that govern library operations and services, and managing library staff and budgets.

Modern library work also involves digital resource management, community engagement, and contributing to open-access initiatives. As noted by IFLA, libraries today not only manage information but also play key roles in promoting equitable access to knowledge and supporting sustainable development goals. Information and library work is dynamic and continually evolving, especially with the advancement of technology and the increasing importance of digital information. Professionals in this field must adapt to new tools, trends, and user expectations to effectively support and enhance access to information.

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SOURCES OF INFORMATION: PRIMARY, SECONDARY, TERTIARY AND GREY LITERATURE.

An information source is a person, thing, or place from which information comes, arises, or is obtained. Information sources can be categorised as primary, secondary or tertiary.

Primary Sources: Primary sources provide direct or firsthand evidence about an event, object, person, or work of art. Examples include:

- **Original Documents**: Diaries, letters, speeches, manuscripts, and official records.
- **Creative Works**: Poetry, novels, music, art, and performances.
- **Relics or Artifacts**: Clothing, tools, buildings, and other physical objects from the past.
- **Research Data**: Raw data from scientific experiments, surveys, and fieldwork.

Primary information sources contain some new idea; or information relating to new invention, new research, or new experiment; or new interpretation of known facts; In such sources new information are formally published for the first time; These sources bring out new information in its original form, i.e., without expanding, reducing, or critically evaluating the information

Secondary Sources

Secondary sources interpret, analyze, or summarize primary sources. They provide secondhand information and commentary from other researchers. Secondary sources of information refer to materials that provide interpretations, analyses, or evaluations of primary sources. These sources are created after an event or a period has passed, offering a reflective or synthesized perspective on historical events, scientific discoveries, or various topics.

Books: Reviews, critical essays, and textbooks.

Biographies: Accounts of people's lives based on primary sources.

Documentaries: Films or videos that analyze historical events or phenomena.

Tertiary Sources: Tertiary sources compile and summarize primary and secondary sources. They provide an overview of a topic. Tertiary sources are reference materials

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that summarize information from other sources, and are often used to get a broad overview of a topic. Tertiary sources of information are compilation and summary resources that aggregate information from primary and secondary sources. These sources distill complex data and knowledge into easily digestible formats, often in encyclopedias, dictionaries, handbooks, or almanacs. Tertiary sources serve as reference materials that provide overviews, summaries, and background information on various topics. Unlike primary and secondary sources, which directly engage with original data or interpretive analyses, tertiary sources focus on organizing and presenting information in a concise and accessible manner. They are particularly useful for individuals seeking introductory or general knowledge on a subject. They offer a convenient starting point before delving into more specialized or in-depth research using primary and secondary sources. Examples of tertiary sources include general encyclopedias, subject-specific encyclopedias, and reference books that provide brief explanations, definitions, and summaries on various topics. . Examples include: encyclopedias, dictionaries, bibliographies, textbooks, directories, almanacs, fact books. Indexes and abstract.

GREY LITERATURE

Grey literature is research and materials produced by organizations outside of the traditional academic and commercial publishing channels. Unlike peer-reviewed articles, grey literature is often not formally published, which can make it harder to find. However, it can be a valuable resource for researchers, policymakers, and practitioners, as it often provides timely and relevant information on specific topics.

Here are some characteristics of grey literature:

- **Not commercially published**

Grey literature is not published as articles in scholarly journals and is not necessarily searchable in standard databases and search engines.

- **Produced by various organizations**

Grey literature can be produced by governments, universities, private companies, non-governmental organizations, and industry.

- **Can be up-to-date**

Grey literature can be more current than literature in scholarly journals because it is produced without the delays and restrictions of commercial publishing.

- **Quality can vary**

Grey literature is not usually peer reviewed, so the quality can vary a great deal.

DIFFERENT TACTICS FOR FINDING GREY RESOURCES

Finding grey literature resources requires different tactics than you'd use for commercially published materials.

Some examples of grey literature include:

- Conference abstracts
- Presentations
- Proceedings
- Dissertations and theses
- Patents
- Regulatory data
- Unpublished trial data
- Policies and procedures

References

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